

SOLICITATION/CONTRACT/ORDER FOR COMMERCIAL PRODUCTS AND COMMERCIAL SERVICES

NOTE: OFFEROR TO COMPLETE BLOCKS 12, 17, 23, 24, AND 30.

1. REQUISITION NUMBER		PAGE 1 OF 35	
2. CONTRACT NUMBER	3. AWARD/EFFECTIVE DATE	4. ORDER NUMBER	5. SOLICITATION NUMBER 140D0426Q0260
			6. SOLICITATION ISSUE DATE 04/09/2026
7. FOR SOLICITATION INFORMATION CALL:		a. NAME Heather Smith	
		b. TELEPHONE NUMBER (No collect calls) 0000000000	
9. ISSUED BY Interior Business Center, AQD Acquisition Services Directorate 381 Elden Street Suite 2000A Herndon VA 20170		10. THIS ACQUISITION IS ☒ UNRESTRICTED OR ☐ SET ASIDE: _____ % FOR: ☐ SMALL BUSINESS ☐ HUBZONE SMALL BUSINESS ☐ SERVICE-DISABLED ☐ VETERAN-OWNED SMALL BUSINESS (SDVOSB) ☐ WOMEN-OWNED SMALL BUSINESS (WOSB) ☐ ECONOMICALLY DISADVANTAGED ☐ WOMEN-OWNED SMALL BUSINESS (EDWOSB) ☐ 8(A) NORTH AMERICAN INDUSTRY CLASSIFICATION STANDARD (NAICS): 611310 SIZE STANDARD: \$34.5	
11. DELIVERY FOR FREE ON BOARD (FOB) DESTINATION UNLESS BLOCK IS MARKED ☒ SEE SCHEDULE	12. DISCOUNT TERMS		
13a. THIS CONTRACT IS A ☐ RATED ORDER UNDER THE DEFENSE PRIORITIES AND ALLOCATIONS SYSTEM - DPAS (15 CFR 700)		13b. RATING	
14. METHOD OF SOLICITATION ☒ REQUEST FOR QUOTE (RFQ) ☐ INVITATION FOR BID (IFB) ☐ REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)		15. DELIVER TO See Schedule	
16. ADMINISTERED BY See Schedule		17a. CONTRACTOR/ OFFEROR CODE _____ FACILITY CODE _____	
18a. PAYMENT WILL BE MADE BY CODE _____		18b. SUBMIT INVOICES TO ADDRESS SHOWN IN BLOCK 18a UNLESS BLOCK BELOW IS CHECKED ☐ SEE ADDENDUM	
17b. CHECK IF REMITTANCE IS DIFFERENT AND PUT SUCH ADDRESS IN OFFER ☐		19. ITEM NO.	
20. SCHEDULE OF SUPPLIES/SERVICES ADMINISTERED BY: Interior Business Center, AQD Acquisition Services Directorate 381 Elden Street Suite 2000A Herndon VA 20170 USA Continued... (Use Reverse and/or Attach Additional Sheets as Necessary)		21. QUANTITY	22. UNIT
23. UNIT PRICE		24. AMOUNT	
25. ACCOUNTING AND APPROPRIATION DATA		26. TOTAL AWARD AMOUNT (For Government Use Only)	
27a. SOLICITATION INCORPORATES BY REFERENCE (FEDERAL ACQUISITION REGULATION) FAR 52.212-1, 52.212-4. ADDENDA FAR 52.212-3 AND 52.212-5 ARE ATTACHED. ☐ ARE ☐ ARE NOT ATTACHED		27b. CONTRACT/PURCHASE ORDER INCORPORATES BY REFERENCE FAR 52.212-4. FAR 52.212-5 IS ATTACHED. ADDENDA ☐ ARE ☐ ARE NOT ATTACHED	
28. CONTRACTOR IS REQUIRED TO SIGN THIS DOCUMENT AND RETURN 1 COPIES TO ISSUING OFFICE. CONTRACTOR AGREES TO FURNISH AND DELIVER ALL ITEMS SET FORTH OR OTHERWISE IDENTIFIED ABOVE AND ON ANY ADDITIONAL SHEETS SUBJECT TO THE TERMS AND CONDITIONS SPECIFIED		29. AWARD OF CONTRACT: REFERENCE _____ OFFER DATED: _____. YOUR OFFER ON SOLICITATION (BLOCK 5), INCLUDING ANY ADDITIONS OR CHANGES WHICH ARE SET FORTH HEREIN, IS ACCEPTED AS TO ITEMS:	
30a. SIGNATURE OF OFFEROR/CONTRACTOR		31a. UNITED STATES OF AMERICA (SIGNATURE OF CONTRACTING OFFICER)	
30b. NAME AND TITLE OF SIGNER (Type or print)	30c. DATE SIGNED	31b. NAME OF CONTRACTING OFFICER (Type or print) Heather Smith	31c. DATE SIGNED

19. ITEM NO.	20. SCHEDULE OF SUPPLIES/SERVICES	21. QUANTITY	22. UNIT	23. UNIT PRICE	24. AMOUNT
	DELIVER TO: The Acquisition Services Directorate (AQD) is issuing this Request for Quotation (RFQ) on behalf of Peace Corps to solicit Universities and institutions of higher education for campus recruitment services. Questions shall be submitted no later 11:00 AM EST on April 17, 2026 via email to Heather_Smith@ibc.doi.gov. Quotes shall be submitted no later than 11:00 AM EST on May 11, 2026 via email to Heather_Smith@ibc.doi.gov.				
00001	Base Period Campus Recruitment Services per PWS Product/Service Code: R799 Product/Service Description: SUPPORT-MANAGEMENT: OTHER Period of Performance: 08/01/2026 to 07/31/2027				
00100	Option Period One Campus Recruitment Services per PWS (Option Line Item) Anticipated Exercise Date Product/Service Code: R799 Continued...				

32a. QUANTITY IN COLUMN 21 HAS BEEN

☐ RECEIVED☐ INSPECTED☐ ACCEPTED, AND CONFORMS TO THE CONTRACT, EXCEPT AS NOTED: _____

32b. SIGNATURE OF AUTHORIZED GOVERNMENT REPRESENTATIVE

32c. DATE

32d. PRINTED NAME AND TITLE OF AUTHORIZED GOVERNMENT REPRESENTATIVE

32e. MAILING ADDRESS OF AUTHORIZED GOVERNMENT REPRESENTATIVE

32f. TELEPHONE NUMBER OF AUTHORIZED GOVERNMENT REPRESENTATIVE

32g. EMAIL OF AUTHORIZED GOVERNMENT REPRESENTATIVE

33. SHIP NUMBER

34. VOUCHER NUMBER

35. AMOUNT VERIFIED
CORRECT FOR

36. PAYMENT

37. CHECK NUMBER

☐ PARTIAL ☐ FINAL☐ COMPLETE ☐ PARTIAL ☐ FINAL

STOCK RECORD (S/R)

40. PAID BY

38. S/R ACCOUNT NUMBER

39. S/R VOUCHER NUMBER

41a. I CERTIFY THIS ACCOUNT IS CORRECT AND PROPER FOR PAYMENT

41b. SIGNATURE AND TITLE OF CERTIFYING OFFICER

41c. DATE

42a. RECEIVED BY (Print)

42b. RECEIVED AT (Location)

42c. DATE RECEIVED (MM/DD/YYYY)

42d. TOTAL CONTAINERS

CONTINUATION SHEET	REFERENCE NO. OF DOCUMENT BEING CONTINUED	PAGES
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NAME OF OFFEROR OR CONTRACTOR

ITEM NO. (A)	SUPPLIES/SERVICES (B)	QUANTITY (C)	UNIT (D)	UNIT PRICE (E)	AMOUNT (F)
00200	Product/Service Description: SUPPORT-MANAGEMENT: OTHER Period of Performance: 08/01/2027 to 07/31/2028				
	Option Period Two Campus Recruitment Services per PWS (Option Line Item) Anticipated Exercise Date Product/Service Code: R799 Product/Service Description: SUPPORT-MANAGEMENT: OTHER Period of Performance: 08/01/2028 to 07/31/2029				
	Option Period Three Campus Recruitment Services per PWS (Option Line Item) Anticipated Exercise Date Product/Service Code: R799 Product/Service Description: SUPPORT-MANAGEMENT: OTHER Period of Performance: 08/01/2029 to 07/31/2030				
00400	Option Period Four Campus Recruitment Service per PWS (Option Line Item) Anticipated Exercise Date Product/Service Code: R799 Product/Service Description: SUPPORT-MANAGEMENT: OTHER Period of Performance: 08/01/2030 to 07/31/2031				

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SECTION 1 - REQUEST FOR QUOTE (RFQ)

1.1 General

The Department of the Interior (DOI) Interior Business Center (IBC) Acquisition Services Directorate (AQD) is issuing this competitive Request for Quotation (RFQ) on behalf of Peace Corps for commercial Campus Recruitment Services in accordance with Revolutionary Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) Overhaul (RFO) Part 12-Acquisition of Commercial Products and Commercial Services. A synopsis was issued in accordance with FAR Part 5.

The North American Industrial Classification System (NAICS) Code: 611310-Colleges, Universities and Professional Schools.

The Product or Service Code (PSC) is R799 - Support- Management: Other.

The Service Contract Labor Act is applicable to this solicitation. Wage determinations will be incorporated into any subsequent awards based on locality.

1.2 Set-Aside Information

A set-aside is not used.

1.3 Anticipated Award Type

The Government anticipates awarding approximately forty (40) individual Firm-Fixed-Price (FFP) Purchase Orders from this solicitation.

1.4 Period of Performance

The anticipated Period of Performance for this Purchase Order is:

Period of Performance	
Base Period	08/01/2026 – 07/31/2027
Option Period 1	08/01/2027 – 07/31/2028
Option Period 2	08/01/2028 – 07/31/2029
Option Period 3	08/01/2029 – 07/31/2030
Option Period 4	08/01/2030 - 07/31/2031
6 Month Option	

1.5 Pricing Schedule

CLIN	Period of Performance	Service Description	Total
00001	Base Period	Campus Recruitment	\$_____
00100	Option Period 1	Campus Recruitment	\$_____
00200	Option Period 2	Campus Recruitment	\$_____

00300	Option Period 3	Campus Recruitment	\$ _____
00400	Option Period 4	Campus Recruitment	\$ _____

SECTION 2 - DESCRIPTION / SPECIFICATIONS

2.1 Specifications

A.1 INTRODUCTION

The Peace Corps intends to award multiple contracts organized into eight geographic sub-regions, to strengthen national recruitment coverage and improve the Agency's ability to meet recruitment priorities, goals, and objectives.

The Peace Corps intends to establish at least one Strat institution in each subregion, expected to range between approximately 1 and 8 Strat institutions per region, depending on competition, institutional capacity, and alignment with recruitment needs.

This procurement is open to U.S. higher education institutions that meet at least one (1) of the following eligibility criteria:

- United States higher education institutions with at least 20,000 undergraduate students; or
- Institutions previously awarded a Strat contract with the Peace Corps.

The Peace Corps seeks to establish national coverage and a balanced portfolio of universities participating in the Strat program to strengthen the agency's recruitment structure across the United States. Historically, larger institutions and prior Strat participants have demonstrated stronger recruitment performance outcomes, including higher lead and applicant volume, stronger conversion rates, and greater alignment with Peace Corps' recruitment goals.

A.1.1 Regional Structure of Strat Program

To ensure balanced national coverage, the Peace Corps has divided the United States into **eight sub-regions**. This structure allows the Agency to:

- Promote equitable regional representation aligned with agency recruitment needs,
- Establish national Strat coverage, with at least 1 institution in each sub-region.
- Allow between 1 and 8 Strat institutions to be awarded in each sub-region, approximately; and
- Build a balanced portfolio of participating institutions capable of contributing to Agency's recruitment priorities, goals, and objectives.

The eight (8) Strat Sub-Regions are:

(1) East North Central (4 states):

- Illinois, Indiana, Michigan, Ohio

(2) Mid-Atlantic (8 states + DC):

- New Jersey, New York, Pennsylvania, Delaware, Maryland, Virginia, West Virginia, District of Columbia

(3) Mountain (8 states):

- Arizona, Colorado, Idaho, Montana, Nevada, New Mexico, Utah, Wyoming

(4) New England (6 states):

- Connecticut, Maine, Massachusetts, New Hampshire, Rhode Island, Vermont

(5) Pacific (5 states):

- Alaska, California, Hawaii, Oregon, Washington

(6) South – East – Central / Atlantic (8 states):

- Alabama, Kentucky, Mississippi, Tennessee, Florida, Georgia, North Carolina, South Carolina

(7) South – West – Central (4 states):

- Arkansas, Louisiana, Oklahoma, Texas

(8) West North Central (8 states)

- Iowa, Kansas, Minnesota, Missouri, Nebraska, North Dakota, South Dakota, Wisconsin

A.2 CONTRACTOR RESPONSIBILITIES

The Contractor shall establish a Peace Corps Campus Recruiting space on campus and provide access to the following campus resources:

- Physical office space with Peace Corps branded signage located in an area that is accessible and highly visible to students. Convenient private space must be easily accessible for the Campus Recruiter to conduct confidential meetings. The Contractor will furnish a bulletin board or some other form of highly visible posting area, a designated telephone (with some form of voice-messaging service), a computer with MS Office Suite software and access to the Internet, office supplies, and access to copier. The Campus Recruiter is forbidden to use a personally owned computer for Peace Corps business.
- Access to the university's room scheduling system so that the Campus Recruiter can reserve larger conference rooms for periodic General Information Meetings and other events, as necessary.
- Online listing for the Peace Corps Campus Recruitment Office in the appropriate category within the institution's Internet webpages. The listing includes the Campus Recruiter's name as well as office location, email address, phone number, recruiter office hours, links to the Peace Corps' website and online resources (i.e., Peace Corps social media sites).
- Direct access or liaison access (via sponsoring university organizations) to email or postal addresses and/or boxes for all faculty, students, and campus associations for the purpose of transmitting special recruitment announcements from the Peace Corps.
- University parking permit for Campus Recruiter if it is a standard part of university employee hiring package. Availability of university parking permits for guests.

- Free access to, or reduced fees for, university-sponsored career fairs and campus media outlets. If a university is not able to secure free or reduced fees for university-sponsored career fairs or campus media outlets, the costs may be included within their pricing quote.
- Virtual Platform: Access to a virtual recruitment technical platform (example Zoom, Teams, etc.) that is to permit virtual sessions as well as in person sessions.

A.3 Hiring and Supervision of Peace Corps Campus Recruiter

The Contractor shall interview and hire a part-time (20 hours per week) Campus Recruiter to staff the Campus Recruitment Office and coordinate campus recruitment activities. Final offers to select the Campus Recruiter can be initiated upon the execution of the contract .

- The Campus Recruiter must be a Returned Peace Corps Volunteer (RPCV), who is approved by the Peace Corps and is to be paid a fair and reasonable hourly rate plus the fringe benefits the Contractor typically offers its part-time employees or graduate students, as the case may be.
- If the contractor is unable to hire a Campus Recruiter due to the RPCV requirement, they may submit a RPCV status exemption request for that contract year to the Peace Corps.

Please use the Peace Corps Campus Recruiter job description template to advertise and promote the position (to be provided after contract award).

The Contractor shall assign an institutional employee to work as the supervisor for the Campus Recruiter.

- Supervisory responsibilities include ensuring the Campus Recruiter is aware of, and working in, a responsible and professional manner to fulfill his or her recruitment strategies and activities. A Peace Corps staff member will work closely with the Campus Recruiter and Supervisor to help ensure they meet the recruitment objectives.

A.4 Campus Recruitment Strategy Plan

The Campus Recruitment Strategy Plan will be focused on achieving recruitment targets that will be shared with the school during training, such as:

1. Conduct **40 unique recruitment events** that align with Peace Corps' service sectors. Unique recruitment events include any of the following types of events (order based on importance):
 - Information tables (ex: career fairs – held in high traffic/target event or areas)
 - Class or club talk
 - Application workshops
 - Information session – general or sector specific
 - Retention event (either Friends & Family or Welcome Back/Send Off)
 - Panel event
2. Conduct public office hours
 - **Minimum of 2 hours per week** for a total minimum of 72 hours per year
3. Conduct **20 unique partnership** connections

4. **Generate** a minimum total of **200 new leads** throughout the year.
5. Generate a minimum of 16 applications for each new school, and produce 15% more applications year-over-year for all returning Strat schools, as well as for new schools in future option years.
6. Email marketing for Strats - Peace Corps has the technical functionality to send targeted marketing emails to students at Strat schools from our internal lead management system, PCrm. These emails will appear to be written and sent by the Strat (school employee), and recipients can reply directly to the Strat's school email address.
 - The goal of this email marketing is to use our technology to amplify the marketing and promotion reach of each Strat with regard to leads at their school, and to reduce the amount of administrative time that Strats spend writing and sending mass emails to their existing leads regarding upcoming events.

Peace Corps will coordinate director with vendors to finalize submitted Plans within 60 days after the Strat is in the position.

A.5 Monthly Progress, Mid-year and Final Reports

- **Monthly Report:** The Contractor shall ensure the Campus Recruiter submits monthly progress reports to the designated Peace Corps representative, or saves this report in a specific location as directed by the Peace Corps, **by the 5th of each month**.
 - *Each report should reflect steady progress toward completion of the contract deliverables. If the 5th is a weekend, the report is due on the next business day.*
 - *Please see **Attachment B** for a sample monthly reporting template. The actual monthly report format to be used throughout the performance period will be provided to the Campus Recruiter at the beginning of every academic year.*
- **Mid-Year Report:** Contractor shall submit a mid-year report to the designated Peace Corps contact **by the 2nd of January**.
 - *The mid-year report format and required information will be provided to the Campus Recruiter at the beginning of every academic year.*
 - *Please see **Attachment C** for a sample.*
- **Final Report:** the Contractor shall submit a final report to the designated Peace Corps contact **within 2 weeks of the last day of Spring finals**.
 - *The final report format and required information will be provided to the Campus Recruiter at the beginning of every academic year.*

A.6 Expected Results

A.6.1 PERFORMANCE MEASUREMENTS – tied to payment:

- (A) A Strat Recruiter is hired and is working on average 20 hours per week.

NOTE: *If a Strat Recruiter is not hired, hired late in the contract work year, or leaves before the end of the contractual work year, the University shall only bill Peace Corps and Peace Corps will only pay for the time period a Strat has been working.*

Payment will be pro-rated based on the following Payment Formula:

- # of weeks in a Year that the school has committed to having a Strat work per the contract DIVIDED by the overall Annual Contract \$\$'s= \$\$'s per week.
 - Payment will be pro-rated based on # of weeks a Strat is hired and working.
 - Full Payment= # Weeks Committed in Contract (same as # of Weeks Worked) x \$\$'s per week
 - Partial Payment= # of Weeks Worked x \$\$'s per week.
- (B) The Campus Recruiter will establish hours of operation for the campus recruitment office, with a minimum of 2 hours per week set and posted as public office hours to meet with potential and current applicants.
- (C) The Campus Recruiter is expected to respond to Peace Corps and campus staff in a timely manner, as well as attend regularly scheduled meetings initiated by Peace Corps.
- (D) Office space and supporting material/resources as detailed in the Contract are provided by the University to the Strat.
- (E) The Contractor will inform the Peace Corps if they are unable to hire a Strategic Campus Recruiter within 90 days after contract execution or in the event of a vacancy during the performance period.
- (F) The contractor will be responsible for the full hiring process, including posting the position, interviewing applicants, and selecting for the position.
- (G) The Strat Recruiter has:
- Taken the mandatory Strat Training(s)
 - Submitted Recruitment Plan(s) in the format and by the deadline provided by Peace Corps for review and approval
 - Submitted Monthly Reports in format and by the deadline provided by Peace Corps
 - Submitted a Mid-Year Report in format and by the deadline provided by Peace Corps
 - Submitted a Final Year-End Report in format and by the deadline provided by Peace Corps.

A.7 PERFORMANCE MEASUREMENTS – to be used to determine option year approval:

- (A) Quality of the approved/final Recruitment Plan(s)
- During the mandatory Strat Training, Peace Corps will provide guidance on activities and deliverables to include in the Recruitment Plan(s) along with recruitment targets.

This guidance will include targets such as:

- i. # and type of Recruitment Events / activities
- ii. # of office hours
- iii. Target # of Leads
- iv. Target # of Applications

- (B) Overall execution and results in relation to the Recruitment Plan approved by the Peace Corps
- (C) Complete monthly, mid-year, and final reports submitted by the deadlines (or by approved alternative date agreed upon by the Peace Corps)
- (D) Strat and/or University point of contact (Strat Administrator/Strat Supervisor) attendance of assigned Peace Corps training)

A.8 Reduction of Contract Payments

- (A) Notwithstanding any other payment provision of this contract, failure of the Contractor to hire a Strat in a timely manner, failure to submit required reports when due or any other failure to deliver, may result in the reduction of payments under this contract. For example, not having an active Strat on the job for a portion of an invoice period, will result in a reduced payment. Exceptions to this reduction in payment will be made on a case-by-case basis, taking into account mitigating circumstances beyond the Contractor's control and without fault or negligence on the part of the Contractor e.g. acts of God.
- (B) Peace Corps, in the interest of equity, will reduce payments in an amount commensurate with the percentage of the 20 hours per week worked e.g. if Strat works 50% of hours (10 hours per week) the payment will be reduced by a commensurate 50%.
- (C) If the Peace Corps intends to reduce a payment of any voucher or invoice in full to \$0, it shall promptly notify the Contractor of its intention to do so. However, if only a portion(s) of the invoice are being reduced, then the voucher may be processed without notification to the Contractor, in order to prevent delay in payment

B. PEACE CORPS RESPONSIBILITIES

B.1 The Peace Corps will:

- Review and approve the Contractor's Recruitment Plan(s).
- Provide Peace Corps recruitment materials to the Campus Recruiter, including printed material, visual aids, and digital resources.
- Provide Peace Corps promotional material to the Campus Recruiter to support their recruitment efforts on campus.
- Provide dashboard Campus Recruiter/Strat recruitment metrics
- Provide training for the Peace Corps Campus Recruiter to accurately inform the student population about Peace Corps program skill needs, length of service, benefits, and legal and medical guidelines. In addition, Campus Recruiters will learn how to assist Peace Corps applicants with the application process - including how to select a position based on their interests and skill sets.

- Provide transport and per diem funds for Peace Corps Campus Recruiter's authorized travel to Peace Corps offices for training and/or meetings and/or to Peace Corps organized Strategic Recruiter specific trainings/meetings/events held at other locations as applicable.
- Assign a Peace Corps staff member to work closely with the Campus Recruiter and Supervisor to ensure objectives of the contract are met.
- Ensure that the assigned Peace Corps staff member will establish and facilitate regular performance and planning meetings with the Campus Recruiter.
- Provide reporting templates to the contractor.
- Provide programming information and performance data regarding trends in program openings and the application pipeline so that the contractor has the necessary information to execute terms of contract.
- Provide a monthly Strat recruitment metrics dashboard.

C. DELIVERIES OR PERFORMANCE

C.1 Period of Performance

The period of performance (POP) for this requirement is one (1) base year and up to four one-year options for a yearly period of August 1 – July 31.

C.2 Deliverables

See **Section A** for full information and listing. All written deliverables shall also be submitted electronically to the appropriate Peace Corps assigned point of contact(s) from the Volunteer Recruitment and Selection Office.

C.3 Place of Performance

The place of performance for this requirement is the United States, or U.S. Territories and Outlying Areas.

In the Performance of this contract, the contractor may work remotely / 'telework' within the United States, or U.S. Territories and Outlying Areas. The contractor shall communicate with the Government employees via telephone, email, and virtual meeting platforms. The Government will not be responsible for any additional costs associated with working remotely.

D. SPECIAL CONTRACT REQUIREMENTS

D.1 Invoices

Electronic invoices with accompanying PDF attachments shall be submitted through the Treasury's Invoice Processing Platform system (IPP) on a quarterly basis. Invoices for each respective quarters can be submitted quarterly. Invoices must be submitted only after the performance and billing period end date. Additional guidance will be provided by the Contracting Officer during the contract awarding process.

D.2 Personnel

The Contractor will hire and supervise a part-time Campus Recruiter to staff the Recruitment Office and coordinate campus recruitment activities. The hired Campus Recruiter will be supervised by an institutional employee assigned by the Contractor. Supervisory responsibilities include ensuring that the Campus Recruiter is aware of and working in a responsible and professional manner to fulfill his or her recruitment strategies and activities.

D.3 Use of Peace Corps Name and Logo (Nov 2008)

The Contractor shall make no publicity announcements or issue other public relations or promotional materials mentioning the Contractor's connection with Peace Corps without first consulting with the Contracting Officer. Furthermore, the Contractor shall not use the Peace Corps name and/or logo in conjunction with, or proximity to, the Contractor's logo, trademark, trade name or facsimile thereof (co-branding) without the advance written concurrence of the Contracting Officer.

D.4 Personnel Security Requirements (Nov 2005)

It is the policy of Peace Corps to exclude from engagement via contractual relationship, including subcontracts, any individuals who have engaged in intelligence activity or related work or who have been employed by or connected with an intelligence agency either directly or by way of contract.

- (a) Each Campus Recruiter is required to complete a background investigation in accordance with University hiring procedures for new staff.
- (b) Once hired, the continuation of a Strat's employment is contingent on the ability of the University to receive a favorable adjudication from the background investigation in accordance with the University hiring procedures for new staff. In the event that a Strat is not cleared through the background check process, their employment will be terminated. Any delay in submission of background check documents may result in termination of employment.
- (c) Peace Corps forbids contractual relationships with any individuals who have engaged in intelligence activity or related work or who have been employed by or connected with an intelligence agency either directly or by way of contract, including subcontracts. If the Contracting Officer, via a determinations & finding memo, concludes a Strategic Recruiter has worked in the intelligence community, the employment will be terminated.

D.5 Observance of Legal Holidays and Administrative Leave (DATE)

(A) Holidays

Peace Corps observes the following days as holidays—

New Year's Day	Martin Luther King Jr. Day	President's Day
Memorial Day	Juneteenth	Independence Day
Labor Day	Columbus Day	Veteran's Day
Thanksgiving Day	Christmas Day	

Any other day designated by Federal law, Executive Order or Presidential Proclamation.

When any holiday specified in (a)(1) falls on a Saturday, the preceding Friday shall be observed. When any such holiday falls on a Sunday, the following Monday shall be observed. Observances of such days by Government personnel shall not be cause for additional period of performance or entitlement to

compensation except as set forth in the contract. If the contractor's personnel work on a holiday, no form of holiday or other premium compensation will be reimbursed either as a direct or indirect cost, unless authorized pursuant to an overtime clause elsewhere in this contract.

(B) Closures

1. Peace Corps may close a Peace Corps facility for all or a portion of a business day as a result of:
 - (a) Granting administrative leave to non-essential Peace Corps employees (e.g., unanticipated holiday);
 - (b) Inclement weather;
 - (c) Failure of Congress to appropriate operational funds;
 - (d) Or any other reason.
2. In such cases, contractor personnel not classified as essential, i.e., not performing critical round-the-clock services or tasks, who are not already on duty at the facility, shall not report to the facility. Such contractor personnel already present shall be dismissed and shall leave the facility.
3. The contractor agrees to continue to provide sufficient personnel to perform round-the-clock requirements of critical tasks already in operation or scheduled for performance during the period in which Peace Corps employees are dismissed, and shall be guided by any specific instructions of the Contracting Officer or his/her duly authorized representative.

(C) When contractor personnel services are not required or provided due to closure of a Peace Corps facility as described in this clause, the contractor shall be compensated as follows—

1. For fixed-price contracts, deductions in the contractor's price will be computed as follows—
 - (a) The deduction rate in dollars per day will be equal to the per month contract price divided by 21 days per month.
 - (b) The deduction rate in dollars per day will be multiplied by the number of days services are not required or provided.

If services are provided for portions of days, appropriate adjustment will be made by the Contracting Officer to ensure that the contractor is compensated for services provided.

D.6 Executive Orders

Peace Corps requires that the vendor comply with all federal Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) requirements in execution if this requirement, including but not limited to the latest Executive Order titled, "Addressing DEI Discrimination by Federal Contractors" dated 3/26/2026.

2.2 GOVERNMENT-FURNISHED PROPERTY

Government-Furnished Property will not be provided under this purchase order.

SECTION 3 - DELIVERABLES

3.1 Deliverables

Deliverable	Description	Quantity/Media	Due Date
1	Annual Recruitment Plan	Written, submitted	Within 60 days of Strat

Deliverable	Description	Quantity/Media	Due Date
		electronically to the assigned Peace Corps point of contact	Assigned
2	Monthly Reports	Written, submitted electronically to the assigned Peace Corps point of contact	By the 5 th of Each Month See Attachment B Sample Monthly Report
3	Mid-Year Report	Written, submitted electronically to the assigned Peace Corps point of contact	January 2 nd See Attachment C Sample Mid-Year and Final Report
4	Final Report	Written, submitted electronically to the assigned Peace Corps point of contact	Within 2 weeks of last day of Spring Finals See Attachment C

SECTION 4 – ADMINISTRATION

4.1 Contractor Administration

TBD at Time of Award

4.2 Government Administration

The Contracting Officer (CO) for this Order is:

Heather Smith

Heather_smith@ibc.doi.gov / 202-601-8987

Department of the Interior / Interior Business Center / Acquisition Services Directorate

The Program Office Receiving Official for this order is:

TBD at Time of Award

Peace Corps / VRS

4.3 Contracting Officer's Authority

The Contracting Officer is the only person authorized to make or approve any changes in the requirement and notwithstanding any provisions contained elsewhere in this requirement, the said authority remains solely in the Contracting Officer. In the event the Contractor makes any changes at the direction of any person other than the Contracting Officer, the change shall be considered to have been made without authority, and no adjustment shall be made in the contract terms and conditions, including price.

4.4 Interpretation of Modification

No oral or written statement of any person and no written statement of anyone other than the Contracting Officer shall modify or otherwise affect the terms or meaning of this requirement. Requests

for interpretations, modifications or changes must be made in writing to the Contracting Officer. The Contracting Officer's Representative (COR) can only respond (verbally or in writing) to technical matters.

4.5 Technical Direction

- (A) Performance of the work under this requirement shall be subject to the technical direction of the Peace Corps Contracting Officer's Representative (COR) as delegated by the Contracting Officer. The term "technical direction" is defined to include, without limitation:
- 1) Providing direction to the contractor that redirects contract efforts, shifts work emphasis between work areas or tasks, requires pursuit of certain lines of inquiry, fills in details, or otherwise serves to accomplish the contractual objectives.
 - 2) Providing written information to the contractor that assists in interpreting drawings, specifications, or technical portions of the work description.
 - 3) Reviewing and, where required by the contract, approving technical reports, drawings, specifications, and technical information to be delivered by the contractor to the Government.
- (B) The contractor will receive a copy of the written COR designation from the contracting officer. It will specify the extent of the COR's authority to act on behalf of the contracting officer. The contractor shall follow only the technical direction from the COR or the Contracting Officer.
- (C) Technical direction must be within the scope of work stated in the contract. The COR does not have the authority to, and may not, issue any technical direction that:
- 1) Constitutes an assignment of additional work outside the Performance Work Statement;
 - 2) Constitutes a change in the terms and conditions of this order;
 - 3) In any manner causes an increase or decrease in the total estimated contract cost, the fee (if any), or the time required for contract performance;
 - 4) Changes any of the expressed terms, conditions or specifications of the contract; or
 - 5) Interferes with the contractor's right to perform the terms and conditions of the contract.
- (D) All technical direction from the COR shall be issued in writing or, if issued orally, he/she will confirm such direction in writing within five calendar days after oral issuance. The COR may issue such guidance via telephone, facsimile, or electronic mail. Electronic mail shall serve as a method of written guidance.
- (E) The contractor must proceed promptly with the performance of technical direction duly issued by the COR. If, in the opinion of the contractor, any instruction or direction by the COR falls within one of the categories defined in (c)(1) through (c)(5), the contractor must **NOT** proceed and must notify the Contracting Officer in writing immediately after receipt of any such instruction or direction and may not proceed with the work further until receiving notification from the Contracting Officer.

SECTION 5 – QUOTATION PREPARATION & SUBMISSION INSTRUCTIONS

5.1 Quotation Preparation Instructions

To be considered for award, Quotations should contain the following information:

- SAM Unique Entity Identifier (UEI)

- Complete business mailing address as it appears in the System for Award Management (SAM) at www.sam.gov
- Contact name, phone number, and e-mail address
- RFQ Number and Strat Sub-Region applicable (Offerors may submit only one quote for the region in which their institution is physically located.)
 - **East North Central (4 states):**
 - Illinois, Indiana, Michigan, Ohio
 - **Mid-Atlantic (8 states + DC):**
 - New Jersey, New York, Pennsylvania, Delaware, Maryland, Virginia, West Virginia, District of Columbia
 - **Mountain (8 states):**
 - Arizona, Colorado, Idaho, Montana, Nevada, New Mexico, Utah, Wyoming
 - **New England (6 states):**
 - Connecticut, Maine, Massachusetts, New Hampshire, Rhode Island, Vermont
 - **Pacific (5 states):**
 - Alaska, California, Hawaii, Oregon, Washington
 - **South – East – Central / Atlantic (8 states):**
 - Alabama, Kentucky, Mississippi, Tennessee, Florida, Georgia, North Carolina, South Carolina
 - **South – West – Central (4 states):**
 - Arkansas, Louisiana, Oklahoma, Texas
 - **West North Central (8 states)**
 - Iowa, Kansas, Minnesota, Missouri, Nebraska, North Dakota, South Dakota, Wisconsin
- School Size and/or previously awarded strat contract number
- Quotation Number
- Completed Attachment A Technical Volume Template
- Completed Attachment D Price Quote Template
- **Pricing Quote** shall contain –
 - The labor rate for each item quoted, extended totals, and Total Order amount (Firm Fixed Price).

Quoters are required to be registered in the System for Award Management (SAM) at www.sam.gov as of the date the quotation is submitted. The SAM registration shall be in “active” status.

A Quotation that does not meet all the requirements specified in this RFQ may not be considered.

5.2 Program Presentation and Submission of Questions

There will be a Peace Corps program presentation regarding the Strat Recruitment Program for all interested quoters.

Zoom webinar

When: Apr 16, 2026 03:00 PM Eastern Time (US and Canada)

Topic: Peace Corps/DOI Strat Contract Outreach

Register in advance for this webinar:

https://peacecorps.zoomgov.com/webinar/register/WN_RUujZAXeSJ-uJgpSvTZnGg

Or an H.323/SIP room system:

H.323: 166.108.98.42 (US West) or 166.108.66.42 (US East)

Meeting ID: 161 522 2620

Passcode: 857697

SIP: 1615222620@sip.zoomgov.com

Passcode: 857697

After registering, you will receive a confirmation email containing information about joining the webinar.

Questions regarding this RFQ should be sent via email to:

Heather_Smith@ibc.doi.gov

Questions shall be submitted no later than 11:00 AM Eastern Time on April 21, 2026.

5.3 Submission of Quotations

The Quotation shall be submitted via EMAIL no later than the date and time specified. It is your responsibility to ensure/verify that the Government receives your submission on or before this date and time. A Quotation received later than this date and time may not be considered.

Assumptions, Conditions, and/or Exceptions

Quoters must submit, under separate cover, all (if any) assumptions, conditions, or exceptions with any of the terms and conditions of this RFQ. If not noted in Attachment A of your quote, it will be assumed that the Quoter proposes no assumptions for award and agrees to comply with all the terms and conditions as set forth herein. It is not the responsibility of the Government to seek out and identify assumptions, conditions, or exceptions buried within the quote.

5.4 Quotation Submission Deadline

The Quotation shall be submitted NO LATER THAN 11:00 AM Eastern Time on May 11, 2026.

The Quote, Attachment A and Attachment D shall be sent via EMAIL to the Contracting Officer at:

Heather_Smith@ibc.doi.gov

The subject line shall include the RFQ 140D0426Q0260 and the Sub-region Number Applicable

SECTION 6 – EVALUATION FACTORS FOR AWARD

6.1 Basis for Award

The Government will initially evaluate all quotes to determine if they comply with the requirements of the RFQ and if they meet one of the two following requirements to be eligible for award:

- United States higher education institutions with at least 20,000 undergraduate students; or
- Institutions previously awarded a Strat contract with the Peace Corps.

Any vendors that do not meet one of these two requirements will be eliminated from competition and will not be evaluated further.

The basis of award will be best value/tradeoff to the Government. It is the Government's intent to award multiple individual contracts to the Responsible Quoters whose quotes, in conforming to the RFQ, will be most advantageous to the Government. Using the best-value tradeoff process, the Government will evaluate each quote in accordance with the evaluation criteria.

Non-Price Factors 1, 2, and 3 when combined are significantly more important than Price Factor 4 in this best value/tradeoff evaluation.

The Government anticipates awarding between 1-8 contracts per region but reserves the right to not award any contracts in one region or more than 8 in a region as a result of this competition if, in the opinion of the Government, none of the submissions would provide satisfactory performance at a price that is considered fair and reasonable and/or economically feasible.

The following Non-Price and Price Factors shall be used to determine the service provider whose Quote represents the best overall value to the Government:

Non-Price Factors:

Factor 1: Technical Capability

Factor 2: Management Approach

Factor 3: Past Performance

Price Factor:

Factor 4: Price

Evaluation of Non-Price Factor 1: Technical Capability

The Government shall evaluate:

The extent to which the Offeror demonstrates its ability to perform the specific tasks outlined in **Section A**: PERFORMANCE WORK STATEMENT(PWS)/SPECIFICATIONS.

The extent to which the technical quote provided which demonstrates ability to perform the required services including establishing a Peace Corps Recruiting Office, implementing a campus-wide Recruitment Strategy Plan, hiring a strategic campus recruiter in a timely fashion, and reporting back to the Peace Corps.

For evaluation purposes, the findings for this Factor shall be aligned with one of the following ratings:

Factor 1: Technical Capability

Confidence Ratings	
Confidence Rating	Description
High Confidence	Little doubt exists that the quoter can perform the required effort with little or no Government intervention
Moderate Confidence	Some doubt exists that the quoter can perform the required effort with some Government intervention.
Low Confidence	Significant doubt exists that the quoter can perform the requirement with considerable Government intervention.
Unacceptable	No doubt exists that the quoter cannot perform the required effort due to material failure or a combination of weaknesses that increases the risk of unsuccessful performance to an unacceptable level.

Evaluation of Non-Price Factor 2: Management Approach

The Government shall evaluate:

The extent to which the Offeror explains how the potential Campus Recruiter will be recruited, hired and supervised to manage the Peace Corps Recruitment Office and carry out recruitment strategies and activities on campus. The hiring timeline for the Campus Recruiter position is also required.

The extent to which the quote explains how an institutional employee will be selected and assigned to work as the supervisor for the Campus Recruiter. Supervisory responsibilities include ensuring that the Campus Recruiter is aware of and working in a responsible and professional manner to fulfill his or her recruitment strategies and activities.

For evaluation purposes, the findings for this Factor shall be aligned with one of the following ratings:

Factor 2: Management Approach Confidence Ratings	
Confidence Rating	Description
High Confidence	Little doubt exists that the quoter can perform the required effort with little or no Government intervention
Moderate Confidence	Some doubt exists that the quoter can perform the required effort with some Government intervention.

Low Confidence	Significant doubt exists that the quoter can perform the requirement with considerable Government intervention.
Unacceptable	No doubt exists that the quoter cannot perform the required effort due to material failure or a combination of weaknesses that increases the risk of unsuccessful performance to an unacceptable level.

Evaluation of Non-Price Factor 3: Past Performance

The Government shall evaluate:

Offeror's past performance on the extent to which the offeror demonstrates successful past performance in the areas described in the Performance Work Statement. In evaluating past performance, the Government may contact the references provided by the offeror and other sources of information, including past work done for Peace Corps.

For evaluation purposes, the findings for this Factor shall be aligned with one of the following ratings:

Factor 3: Past Performance Confidence Ratings	
Rating	Description
High Confidence	The Government has high confidence the Quoter will successfully perform the required effort based on the analysis of the Quoter's past performance record.
Moderate Confidence	The Government has some confidence the Quoter will successfully perform the required effort based on the analysis of the Quoter's past performance record.
Low Confidence	The Government has minimal confidence the Quoter will successfully perform the required effort based on the analysis of the Quoter's past performance record.
Neutral	No significant performance record is identified.

Evaluation of Price Factor 4: Price

Price quotes shall be evaluated separately. Price elements will be compared to estimates based on market research. Where the technical capabilities of two Contractors' quotes are considered essentially equal, price may be the determining factor in selecting a Contractor for award.

Price quotes will be evaluated within each region consistent with the region-based competition structure. Offerors may only submit a price quote for the region in which their institution is located. Because approximately 1 to 8 Strat institutions may be awarded per region, pricing will be assessed independently at the regional level to ensure fair competition and best-value outcomes.

The Government will evaluate the provided Quote for award purposes by adding the total price for all Options to the total price for the basic requirement (Base Period). The Government may determine that a quote is unacceptable if the option prices are significantly unbalanced. Price will be evaluated based on the Quoter's price assumptions, an analysis of the overall price and components of the overall price and for price reasonableness. Evaluation of options shall not obligate the Government to exercise the Option(s).

Submission of a quote implies the Quoter agrees to the terms and conditions in this document.

The Government reserves the right to not issue an award from this RFQ or from a particular strat sub-region. This is an RFQ only and in no way obligates the Government to award a Purchase Order or to reimburse the Quoter for any costs incurred in preparing the response to this RFQ.

SECTION 7 – CONTRACT CLAUSES

System updates may lag policy updates. The System for Award Management (SAM) may continue to require entities to complete representations based on provisions that are not included in agency solicitations. Examples include 52.222-25, Affirmative Action Compliance, and paragraph (d) of 52.212-3, Offeror Representations and Certifications—Commercial Products and Commercial Services. Contracting officers will not consider these representations when making award decisions or enforce requirements. Entities are not required to, nor are they able to, update their entity registration to remove these representations in SAM.

52.252-2 Clauses Incorporated by Reference (FEB 1998)

This contract incorporates one or more clauses by reference, with the same force and effect as if they were given in full text. Upon request, the Contracting Officer will make their full text available. Also, the full text of a clause may be accessed electronically at this/these address(es): <https://acquisition.gov/>

* Denotes clauses that are only Applicable to Quotes that exceed the Simplified Acquisition Threshold

The contract clauses included by reference are:

Clause	Title	Date
52.203-6*	Restrictions on Subcontractor Sales to the Government Alt I	JUN 2020
52.203-17	Contractor Employee Whistleblower Rights	NOV 2023
52.203-19	Prohibition on Requiring Certain Internal Confidentiality Agreements or Statements	JAN 2017
52.204-13	System for Award Management Maintenance	OCT 2018
52.204-19	Incorporation by Reference of Representations and Certifications	DEC 2014
52.209-6	Protecting the Government's Interest When Subcontracting with Contractors Debarred, Suspended, or Proposed for Debarment	JAN 2025
52.204-91	Contractor Identification	
52.209-10	Prohibition on Contracting with Inverted Domestic Corporations	NOV 2015
52.212-4	Contract Terms and Conditions—Commercial Products and Commercial Services	NOV 2023
52.222-3	Convict Labor	JUN 2003

Clause	Title	Date
52.222-35	Equal Opportunity for Veterans	JUN 2020
52.222-36	Equal Opportunity for Workers with Disabilities	JUN 2020
52.222-37	Employment Reports on Veterans	JUN 2020
52.222-40*	Notification of Employee Rights Under the National Labor Relations Act	DEC 2010
52.222-41	Service Contract Labor Standards	AUG 2018
52.222-42	Statement of Equivalent Rates for Federal Hires	MAY 2014
52.222-44*	Fair Labor Standards Act and Service Contract Labor Standards—Price Adjustment	MAY 2014
52.222-49	Service Contract Labor Standards—Place of Performance Unknown	MAY 2014
52.222-50	Combating Trafficking in Persons	OCT 2025
52.222-54	Employment Eligibility Verification	JAN 2025
52.226-8	Encouraging Contractor Policies to Ban Text Messaging While Driving	MAY 2024
52.229-12*	Tax on Certain Foreign Procurements	FEB 2021
52.232-33	Payment by Electronic Funds Transfer—System for Award Management	OCT 2018
52.232-40	Providing Accelerated Payments to Small Business Subcontractors	MAR 2023
52.233-4	Applicable Law for Breach of Contract Claim	OCT 2004
52.240-91	Security Prohibitions and Exclusions	DEC 2025

Clauses Incorporated by Full Text

52.217-8 Option to Extend Services (Nov 1999)

The Government may require continued performance of any services within the limits and at the rates specified in the contract. These rates may be adjusted only as a result of revisions to prevailing labor rates provided by the Secretary of Labor. The option provision may be exercised more than once, but the total extension of performance hereunder shall not exceed 6 months. The Contracting Officer may exercise the option by written notice to the Contractor within 7 days of Order expiration.

52.217-9 Option to Extend the Term of the Contract (Mar 2000)

(a) The Government may extend the term of this contract by written notice to the Contractor within 1 Day of Order Expiration; provided that the Government gives the Contractor a preliminary written notice of its intent to extend at least 7 days before the contract expires. The preliminary notice does not commit the Government to an extension.

(b) If the Government exercises this option, the extended contract shall be considered to include this option clause.

(c) The total duration of this contract, including the exercise of any options under this clause, shall not exceed 60 months.

52.222-49 Service Contract Labor Standards-Place of Performance Unknown.

Service Contract Labor Standards-Place of Performance Unknown (May 2014)

(a) This contract is subject to the Service Contract Labor Standards statute, and the place of performance was unknown when the solicitation was issued. In addition to places or areas identified in wage determinations, if any, attached to the solicitation, wage determinations have also been requested for the following: *Nationwide*. The Contracting Officer will request wage determinations for additional places or areas of performance if asked to do so in writing by *April 21, 2026*.

(b) Offerors who intend to perform in a place or area of performance for which a wage determination has not been attached or requested may nevertheless submit bids or proposals. However, a wage determination shall be requested and incorporated in the resultant contract retroactive to the date of contract award, and there shall be no adjustment in the contract price.

(End of clause)

52.223-23 Sustainable Products and Services (MAY 2024) (DEVIATION FEB 2025)

(a) Definitions. As used in this clause—

Biobased product means a product determined by the U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) to be a commercial product or industrial product (other than food or feed) that is composed, in whole or in significant part, of biological products, including renewable domestic agricultural materials and forestry materials, or that is an intermediate ingredient or feedstock. The term includes, with respect to forestry materials, forest products that meet biobased content requirements, notwithstanding the market share the product holds, the age of the product, or whether the market for the product is new or emerging. (7 U.S.C. 8101) (7 CFR part 4270.2).

Recovered material means waste materials and by-products recovered or diverted from solid waste, but the term does not include those materials and by-products generated from, and commonly reused within, an original manufacturing process. (42 U.S.C. 6903).

Sustainable products and services means:

(1) Products containing recovered material designated by the U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) under the Comprehensive Procurement Guidelines (42 U.S.C. 6962) (40 CFR part 247) (<https://www.epa.gov/smm/comprehensive-procurement-guideline-cpg-program#products>).

(2) Energy- and water-efficient products that are ENERGY STAR® certified or Federal Energy Management Program (FEMP) -designated products (42 U.S.C. 8259b) (10 CFR part 436, subpart C) (<https://www.energy.gov/eere/femp/search-energy-efficient-products> and <https://www.energystar.gov/products?s=mega>).

(3) Biobased products meeting the content requirement of the USDA under the BioPreferred® program (7 U.S.C. 8102) (7 CFR part 3201) (<https://www.biopreferred.gov>).

(4) Acceptable chemicals, products, and manufacturing processes listed under EPA's Significant New Alternatives Policy (SNAP) program, which ensures a safe and smooth transition away from substances that contribute to the depletion of stratospheric ozone (42 U.S.C. 7671l) (40 CFR part 82, subpart G) (<https://www.epa.gov/snap>).

(b) Requirements.

(1) The sustainable products and services, including the purchasing program and type of product or service, that are applicable to this contract, and any products or services that are not subject to this clause, will be set forth in the statement of work or elsewhere in the contract.

(2) The Contractor shall ensure that the sustainable products and services required by this contract are—

(i) Delivered to the Government;

(ii) Furnished for use by the Government;

(iii) Incorporated into the construction of a public building or public work; and

(iv) Furnished for use in performing services under this contract, where the cost of the products is a direct cost to this contract (versus costs which are normally applied to the Contractor's general and administrative expenses or indirect costs). This includes services performed by contractors performing management and operation of Government-owned facilities to the same extent that, at the time of award, an agency would be required to comply if an agency operated or supported the facility.

(c) Resource. The Green Procurement Compilation (GPC) available at <https://sftool.gov/green> procurement provides a comprehensive list of sustainable products and services and sustainable acquisition guidance. The Contractor should review the GPC when determining which statutory purchasing programs apply to a specific product or service.

52.252-6 Authorized Deviations in Clauses (NOV 2020)

(a) The use in this solicitation or contract of any Federal Acquisition Regulation (48 CFR Chapter 1) clause with an authorized deviation is indicated by the addition of "(DEVIATION)" after the date of the clause.

(b) The use in this solicitation or contract of any Department of the Interior Acquisition Regulation (48 CFR Chapter 14) clause with an authorized deviation is indicated by the addition of "(DEVIATION)" after the name of the regulation.

DIAR 1452.201-70 - Authorities and Delegations (SEP 2011)

(a) The Contracting Officer is the only individual authorized to enter into or terminate this contract, modify any term or condition of this contract, waive any requirement of this contract, or accept nonconforming work.

(b) The Contracting Officer will designate a Contracting Officer's Representative (COR) at time of award. The COR will be responsible for technical monitoring of the contractor's performance and deliveries. The COR will be appointed in writing, and a copy of the appointment will be furnished to the Contractor. Changes to this delegation will be made by written changes to the existing appointment or by issuance of a new appointment.

(c) The COR is not authorized to perform, formally or informally, any of the following actions:

(1) Promise, award, agree to award, or execute any contract, contract modification, or notice of intent that changes or may change this contract;

(2) Waive or agree to modification of the delivery schedule;

- (3) Make any final decision on any contract matter subject to the Disputes Clause;
- (4) Terminate, for any reason, the Contractor's right to proceed;
- (5) Obligate in any way, the payment of money by the Government.
- (d) The Contractor shall comply with the written or oral direction of the Contracting Officer or authorized representative(s) acting within the scope and authority of the appointment memorandum. The Contractor need not proceed with direction that it considers to have been issued without proper authority. The Contractor shall notify the Contracting Officer in writing, with as much detail as possible, when the COR has taken an action or has issued direction (written or oral) that the Contractor considers to exceed the COR's appointment, within 3 days of the occurrence. Unless otherwise provided in this contract, the Contractor assumes all costs, risks, liabilities, and consequences of performing any work it is directed to perform that falls within any of the categories defined in paragraph (c) prior to receipt of the Contracting Officer's response issued under paragraph (e) of this clause.
- (e) The Contracting Officer shall respond in writing within 30 days to any notice made under paragraph (d) of this clause. A failure of the parties to agree upon the nature of a direction, or upon the contract action to be taken with respect thereto, shall be subject to the provisions of the Disputes clause of this contract.
- (f) The Contractor shall provide copies of all correspondence to the Contracting Officer and the COR.
- (g) Any action(s) taken by the Contractor, in response to any direction given by any person acting on behalf of the Government or any Government official other than the Contracting Officer or the COR acting within his or her appointment, shall be at the Contractor's risk.

DIAR 1452.203-70 - Restriction on Endorsements (Jul 1996)

The Contractor shall not refer to contracts awarded by the Department of the Interior in commercial advertising, as defined in FAR 31.205-1, in a manner which states or implies that the product or service provided is approved or endorsed by the Government, or is considered by the Government to be superior to other products or services. This restriction is intended to avoid the appearance of preference by the Government toward any product or service. The Contractor may request the Contracting Officer to make a determination as to the propriety of promotional material.

Electronic Invoicing and Payment Requirements – Invoice Processing Platform (IPP) (February 2021)

Payment requests must be submitted electronically through the U. S. Department of the Treasury's Invoice Processing Platform System (IPP).

"Payment request" means any request for contract financing payment or invoice payment by the Contractor. To constitute a proper invoice, the payment request must comply with the requirements identified in the applicable Prompt Payment clause included in the contract, or the clause 52.212-4 Contract Terms and Conditions – Commercial Items included in commercial item contracts. The IPP website address is: <https://www.ipp.gov>.

Under this contract, the following documents are required to be submitted as an attachment to the IPP invoice:

An electronic copy of the proper invoice with the contents outlined in FAR 32.905(b)

Invoices may only be submitted on a quarterly basis.

The Contractor must use the IPP website to register, access and use IPP for submitting requests for payment. The Contractor Government Business Point of Contact (as listed in SAM) will receive enrollment instructions via email from the Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis (FRBSTL) within 3 – 5 business days of the contract award date. Contractor assistance with enrollment can be obtained by contacting the IPP Production Helpdesk via email **IPPCustomerSupport@fiscal.treasury.gov** or phone **(866) 973-3131**.

If the Contractor is unable to comply with the requirement to use IPP for submitting invoices for payment, the Contractor must submit a waiver request in writing to the Contracting Officer with its quote or quotation.

***AQD Custom Clause - Contractor Performance Assessment Reporting System (DEC 2015) (DOI-AAAP-0050)**

1. FAR 42.1502 directs all Federal agencies to collect past performance information on contracts. The Department of the Interior (DOI) has implemented the Contractor Performance Assessment Reporting System (CPARS) to comply with this regulation. One or more past performance evaluations will be conducted in order to record your contract performance as required by FAR 42.15.
2. The past performance evaluation process is a totally paperless process using CPARS. CPARS is a web-based system that allows for electronic processing of the performance evaluation report. Once the report is processed, it is available in the Past Performance Information Retrieval System (PPIRS) for Government use in evaluating past performance as part of a source selection action.
3. We request that you furnish the Contracting Officer (CO) with the name, position title, phone number, and email address for each person designated to have access to your firm's past performance evaluation(s) for the contract no later than 30 days after award. Each person granted access will have the ability to provide comments in the Contractor portion of the report and state whether or not the Contractor agrees with the evaluation, before returning the report to the Assessing Official (AO). Information in the report must be protected as source selection sensitive information not releasable to the public.
4. When your Contractor Representative(s) are registered in CPARS, they will receive an automatically generated email with detailed login instructions. Further details, systems requirements, and training information for CPARS is available at <https://www.cpars.gov/>.
5. Within 60 days after the end of a performance period, the AO will complete an interim or final past performance evaluation, and the report will be accessible at <https://www.cpars.gov/>.
 - i. Contractor Representatives may then provide comments in response to the evaluation, or return the evaluation without comment.
 - ii. Your comments should focus on objective facts in the AO's narrative and should a) provide your views on the causes and ramifications of the assessed performance.
 - iii. All information provided should be reviewed for accuracy prior to submission.
 - iv. If you elect not to provide comments, please acknowledge receipt of the evaluation by indicating "No comment" in the space provided, and then selecting "Accept the Ratings and Close the Evaluation".

v. Your response is due within 60 calendar days after receipt of the CPAR. On day 15, the evaluation will become available in PPIRS-RC marked as "Pending" with or without comments and whether or not it has been closed.

vi. If you do not sign and submit the CPAR within 60 days, it will automatically be returned to the Government and will be annotated: "The report was delivered/received by the contractor on (date). The contractor neither signed nor offered comment in response to this assessment."

6. The following guidelines apply concerning your use of the past performance evaluation:

i. Protect the evaluation as source selection information. After review, transmit the evaluation by completing and submitting the form through CPARS. If for some reason you are unable to view and/or submit the form through CPARS, contact the CO for instructions.

ii. Strictly control access to the evaluation within your organization. Ensure the evaluation is never released to persons or entities outside of your control.

iii. Prohibit the use of or reference to evaluation data for advertising, promotional material, pre-award surveys, responsibility determinations, production readiness reviews, or other similar purposes.

7. If you wish to discuss a past performance evaluation, you should request a meeting in writing to the CO no later than seven days following your receipt of the evaluation. The meeting will be held in person or via telephone or other means during your 60-day review period.

8. A copy of the completed past performance evaluation will be available in CPARS for your viewing and for Government use supporting source selection actions after it has been finalized.

SECTION 8 – SOLICITATION PROVISIONS

* Denotes provisions that are only Applicable to Quotes that exceed the Simplified Acquisition Threshold

52.252-1 Solicitation Provisions Incorporated by Reference (FEB 1998)

This solicitation incorporates one or more solicitation provisions by reference, with the same force and effect as if they were given in full text. Upon request, the Contracting Officer will make their full text available. The offeror is cautioned that the listed provisions may include blocks that must be completed by the offeror and submitted with its quotation or offer. In lieu of submitting the full text of those provisions, the offeror may identify the provision by paragraph identifier and provide the appropriate information with its quotation or offer. Also, the full text of a solicitation provision may be accessed electronically at this/these address(es): <https://acquisition.gov/>

The solicitation provisions included by reference are:

Provision	Title	Date
52.203-11	Certification and Disclosure Regarding Payments to Influence Certain Federal Transactions	SEP 2024
52.203-18	Prohibition on Contracting with Entities that Require Certain Internal Confidentiality Agreements or Statements—Representation	JAN 2017
52.204-7	System for Award Management	OCT 2018
52.204-90	Offeror Identification	MAR 2026
52.212-1	Instructions to Offerors—Commercial Products and Commercial Services	SEP 2023

Provision	Title	Date
52.222-48	Exemption from Application of the Service Contract Labor Standards to Contracts for Maintenance, Calibration, or Repair of Certain Equipment-Certification	MAY 2014
52.229-11*	Tax on Certain Foreign Procurements—Notice and Representation	JUN 2020
52.240-90	Security Prohibitions and Exclusions Representations and Certifications	DEC 2025

Provisions Incorporated by Full Text

52.209-11 Representation by Corporations Regarding Delinquent Tax Liability or a Felony Conviction under any Federal Law (FEB 2016)

(a) As required by sections 744 and 745 of Division E of the Consolidated and Further Continuing Appropriations Act, 2015 (Pub. L 113-235), and similar provisions, if contained in subsequent appropriations acts, the Government will not enter into a contract with any corporation that--

(1) Has any unpaid Federal tax liability that has been assessed, for which all judicial and administrative remedies have been exhausted or have lapsed, and that is not being paid in a timely manner pursuant to an agreement with the authority responsible for collecting the tax liability, where the awarding agency is aware of the unpaid tax liability, unless an agency has considered suspension or debarment of the corporation and made a determination that suspension or debarment is not necessary to protect the interests of the Government; or

(2) Was convicted of a felony criminal violation under any Federal law within the preceding 24 months, where the awarding agency is aware of the conviction, unless an agency has considered suspension or debarment of the corporation and made a determination that this action is not necessary to protect the interests of the Government.

(b) The Offeror represents that—

(1) It is ☐ is not ☐ a corporation that has any unpaid Federal tax liability that has been assessed, for which all judicial and administrative remedies have been exhausted or have lapsed, and that is not being paid in a timely manner pursuant to an agreement with the authority responsible for collecting the tax liability; and

(2) It is ☐ is not ☐ a corporation that was convicted of a felony criminal violation under a Federal law within the preceding 24 months.

52.217-5 -- Evaluation of Options (Jul 1990)

Except when it is determined in accordance with FAR 17.206(b) not to be in the Government's best interests, the Government will evaluate offers for award purposes by adding the total price for all options to the total price for the basic requirement. Evaluation of options will not obligate the Government to exercise the option(s).

52.252-5 Authorized Deviations in Provisions

(a) The use in this solicitation of any Federal Acquisition Regulation (48 CFR Chapter 1) provision with an authorized deviation is indicated by the addition of "(DEVIATION)" after the date of the provision.

(b) The use in this solicitation of any Department of the Interior Acquisition Regulation (48 CFR Chapter 14) provision with an authorized deviation is indicated by the addition of "(DEVIATION)" after the name of the regulation.

DIAR 1452.215-71 Use and Disclosure of Proposal Information - Department of the Interior (APR 1984)

(a) Definitions. For the purposes of this provision and the Freedom of Information Act (5 U.S.C. 552), the following terms shall have the meaning set forth below:

(1) "Trade Secret" means an unpatented, secret, commercially valuable plan, appliance, formula, or process, which is used for making, preparing, compounding, treating or processing articles or materials which are trade commodities.

(2) "Confidential commercial or financial information" means any business information (other than trade secrets) which is exempt from the mandatory disclosure requirement of the Freedom of Information Act, 5 U.S.C. 552. Exemptions from mandatory disclosure which may be applicable to business information contained in proposals include exemption (4), which covers "commercial and financial information obtained from a person and privileged or confidential," and exemption (9), which covers "geological and geophysical information, including maps, concerning wells."

(b) If the offeror, or its subcontractor(s), believes that the proposal contains trade secrets or confidential commercial or financial information exempt from disclosure under the Freedom of Information Act, (5 U.S.C. 552), the cover page of each copy of the proposal shall be marked with the following legend:

"The information specifically identified on pages _____ of this proposal constitutes trade secrets or confidential commercial and financial information which the offeror believes to be exempt from disclosure under the Freedom of Information Act. The offeror requests that this information not be disclosed to the public, except as may be required by law. The offeror also requests that this information not be used in whole or part by the government for any purpose other than to evaluate the proposal, except that if a contract is awarded to the offeror as a result of or in connection with the submission of the proposal, the Government shall have the right to use the information to the extent provided in the contract."

(c) The offeror shall also specifically identify trade secret information and confidential commercial and financial information on the pages of the proposal on which it appears and shall mark each such page with the following legend:

"This page contains trade secrets or confidential commercial and financial information which the offeror believes to be exempt from disclosure under the Freedom of Information Act and which is subject to the legend contained on the cover page of this proposal."

(d) Information in a proposal identified by an offeror as trade secret information or confidential commercial and financial information shall be used by the Government only for the purpose of evaluating the proposal, except that (i) if a contract is awarded to the offeror as a result of or in connection with submission of the proposal, the Government shall have the right to use the information as provided in the contract, and (ii) if the same information is obtained from another source without restriction it may be used without restriction.

(e) If a request under the Freedom of Information Act seeks access to information in a proposal identified as trade secret information or confidential commercial and financial information, full consideration will

be given to the offeror's view that the information constitutes trade secrets or confidential commercial or financial information. The offeror will also be promptly notified of the request and given an opportunity to provide additional evidence and argument in support of its position, unless administratively unfeasible to do so. If it is determined that information claimed by the offeror to be trade secret information or confidential commercial or financial information is not exempt from disclosure under the Freedom of Information Act, the offeror will be notified of this determination prior to disclosure of the information.

(f) The Government assumes no liability for the disclosure or use of information contained in a proposal if not marked in accordance with paragraphs (b) and (c) of this provision. If a request under the Freedom of Information Act is made for information in a proposal not marked in accordance with paragraphs (b) and (c) of this provision, the offeror concerned shall be promptly notified of the request and given an opportunity to provide its position to the Government. However, failure of an offeror to mark information contained in a proposal as trade secret information or confidential commercial or financial information will be treated by the Government as evidence that the information is not exempt from disclosure under the Freedom of Information Act, absent a showing that the failure to mark was due to unusual or extenuating circumstances, such as a showing that the offeror had intended to mark, but that markings were omitted from the offeror's proposal due to clerical error.

se and Disclosure of Proposal Information - Department of the Interior (APR 1984)

(a) Definitions. For the purposes of this provision and the Freedom of Information Act (5 U.S.C. 552), the following terms shall have the meaning set forth below:

(1) "Trade Secret" means an unpatented, secret, commercially valuable plan, appliance, formula, or process, which is used for making, preparing, compounding, treating or processing articles or materials which are trade commodities.

(2) "Confidential commercial or financial information" means any business information (other than trade secrets) which is exempt from the mandatory disclosure requirement of the Freedom of Information Act, 5 U.S.C. 552. Exemptions from mandatory disclosure which may be applicable to business information contained in proposals include exemption (4), which covers "commercial and financial information obtained from a person and privileged or confidential," and exemption (9), which covers "geological and geophysical information, including maps, concerning wells."

(b) If the offeror, or its subcontractor(s), believes that the proposal contains trade secrets or confidential commercial or financial information exempt from disclosure under the Freedom of Information Act, (5 U.S.C. 552), the cover page of each copy of the proposal shall be marked with the following legend:

"The information specifically identified on pages _____ of this proposal constitutes trade secrets or confidential commercial and financial information which the offeror believes to be exempt from disclosure under the Freedom of Information Act. The offeror requests that this information not be disclosed to the public, except as may be required by law. The offeror also requests that this information not be used in whole or part by the government for any purpose other than to evaluate the proposal, except that if a contract is awarded to the offeror as a result of or in connection with the submission of the proposal, the Government shall have the right to use the information to the extent provided in the contract."

(c) The offeror shall also specifically identify trade secret information and confidential commercial and financial information on the pages of the proposal on which it appears and shall mark each such page with the following legend:

“This page contains trade secrets or confidential commercial and financial information which the offeror believes to be exempt from disclosure under the Freedom of Information Act and which is subject to the legend contained on the cover page of this proposal.”

(d) Information in a proposal identified by an offeror as trade secret information or confidential commercial and financial information shall be used by the Government only for the purpose of evaluating the proposal, except that (i) if a contract is awarded to the offeror as a result of or in connection with submission of the proposal, the Government shall have the right to use the information as provided in the contract, and (ii) if the same information is obtained from another source without restriction it may be used without restriction.

(e) If a request under the Freedom of Information Act seeks access to information in a proposal identified as trade secret information or confidential commercial and financial information, full consideration will be given to the offeror's view that the information constitutes trade secrets or confidential commercial or financial information. The offeror will also be promptly notified of the request and given an opportunity to provide additional evidence and argument in support of its position, unless administratively unfeasible to do so. If it is determined that information claimed by the offeror to be trade secret information or confidential commercial or financial information is not exempt from disclosure under the Freedom of Information Act, the offeror will be notified of this determination prior to disclosure of the information.

(f) The Government assumes no liability for the disclosure or use of information contained in a proposal if not marked in accordance with paragraphs (b) and (c) of this provision. If a request under the Freedom of Information Act is made for information in a proposal not marked in accordance with paragraphs (b) and (c) of this provision, the offeror concerned shall be promptly notified of the request and given an opportunity to provide its position to the Government. However, failure of an offeror to mark information contained in a proposal as trade secret information or confidential commercial or financial information will be treated by the Government as evidence that the information is not exempt from disclosure under the Freedom of Information Act, absent a showing that the failure to mark was due to unusual or extenuating circumstances, such as a showing that the offeror had intended to mark, but that markings were omitted from the offeror's proposal due to clerical error.

*** DIAR 1452.233-2 Service of Protest (JUL 1996) (Deviation)**

a) Protests, as defined in section 33.101 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation, that are filed directly with an agency, and copies of any protests that are filed with the Government Accountability Office (GAO), shall be served on the Contracting Officer (addressed as follows) by obtaining written and dated acknowledgment of receipt from:

Heather Smith
Heather_Smith@ibc.doi.gov

(b) The copy of any protest shall be received in the office designated above within one day of filing a protest with the GAO.

(c) A copy of the protest served on the Contracting Officer shall be simultaneously furnished by the protester to the Department of the Interior Assistant Solicitor, Acquisitions and Intellectual Property, 1849 C Street, NW., Room 6511, Washington, DC 20240.

AQD Evaluation of Options Provision (March 2022)

The Government will evaluate offers for award purposes by adding the total price for all options to the total price for the basic award. To account for the possible use of the additional six-month option period under 52.217-8, the Government will take the price for the final (or highest priced) option period, prorated to a six-month value, and add it to the sum of the base plus all option periods. The agency's price evaluation will mathematically document the calculation of adding the six months of services for the option to extend services to the total contract price in the award summary.

This amount will be used for comparative evaluation purposes only. The Government may determine that an offer is unacceptable if the option prices are significantly unbalanced. Evaluation of options shall not obligate the Government to exercise the options.

FAR 52.217-8 can be exercised at any point during the period of performance of the contract and applied to the period of performance immediately preceding exercising the option.

AQD Custom Provision – SECTION 508 APPLICABLE STANDARDS

The resources acquired in this investment must meet all applicable standards established by the Access Board in 36 CFR Part 1194, including technical, functional performance, information, documentation, and support standards. The products, services, information and data that are provided to the Government or the public as a result of this acquisition shall afford individuals with disabilities access comparable to that afforded to individuals without disabilities.

The full text of the above referenced standards can be found at: <http://www.section508.gov>.

SECTION 9 - ATTACHMENTS

Attachment A -Technical Volume Template

Attachment B -Sample Monthly Reporting Template

Attachment C -Sample Mid-Year and Final Report

Attachment D - Price Quote Template

Attachment E - QASP draft